

CHANGING BALL BEARING IN THE FORESTAY SWIVEL

To remove the Swivel from the aluminum profile you first have to dismount the furling motor and gearbox. How to do this dismounting is well described in the document *"How to service the forestay and or jib furling motor/gearbox"* so that will not be covered here. Though that the dismount of the whole furling gearbox/motor was more difficult than expressed in the document, where the hardest part was to get the forestay wire loose.



The swivel with the Guide Rods and the Balloner lock dismounted



The three main parts of the swivel



1. GRP tube (broken) that goes into #2.
2. Inner part of the swivel
3. Outer part of the swivel that goes over #2



The swivel from the top.



5. Remove the two small plastic ball-stoppers that covers the hole for the bearing balls for the top ball bearing. After that it is easy to remove the balls. All balls have to be removed and replaced through this hole before you are able to separate the two swivel parts.
6. This guides can be dismounted by unscrewing the #4, must be done to be able to remove the plastic tube.
7. Dismount the "horns" / guide rods

Here is the swivel, the "from the bottom side"





- 8. Protection for the locking mechanism for the balloner when sailing the Amel way.
- 9. The locking mechanism. When mounted on the forestay this should point down wards.
- 10. Bolt to remove the locking mechanism, another one is on the opposite side.



- 11. GRP tube that goes on the aluminium profile and inside the swivel to keep the ball bearings in place. Ours is damaged, it is not supposed to look like this at all.



The old to the left and the new to the right. There is some wear and tear on the tube, our old is about 0,5 mm thinner than the new one. Our old is 16 years old and have made some 60 000 nautical miles. To get a new one from Amel was easy. You just have to know the diameter of the aluminumprofile on the forstay.



One of our two damaged bearing balls. Size of the balls are 9,5 mm.



12. If your GRP tube is intact unscrew this part to remove the guides that are keeping the tube in place. You can now move the tube up or down to be able to remove the ball bearings.
13. The lower and upper ball bearing track on the inner part.

When all the balls were removed it was just to separate the two swivel parts and take the tube out.



14. Where the halyard shackle is mounted on the upper side of the outer swivel part.

15. Where the "horns" / guide rods are mounted

16. The small plastic ball stopper in place





The lower ball bearing track on the outer part of the swivel.



Where the halyard shackle is mounted.

We had lost two balls, here are the rest!

When mounting together again those two plastic pieces are to be around the forstay wire when it has been put in place in the gearbox. Mount those plastic parts from the top on each side of the wire.





The measurements are in mm.

A photograph taken from the deck of a boat, looking out towards a marina. In the foreground, a silver metal mast or pole is visible, with a white base and a black handle. A black rope is tied to the base. The deck is made of light-colored wood. In the background, several other boats are docked at a wooden pier. The water is calm, and the sky is overcast with grey clouds.



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